

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Auto-starting Viruses

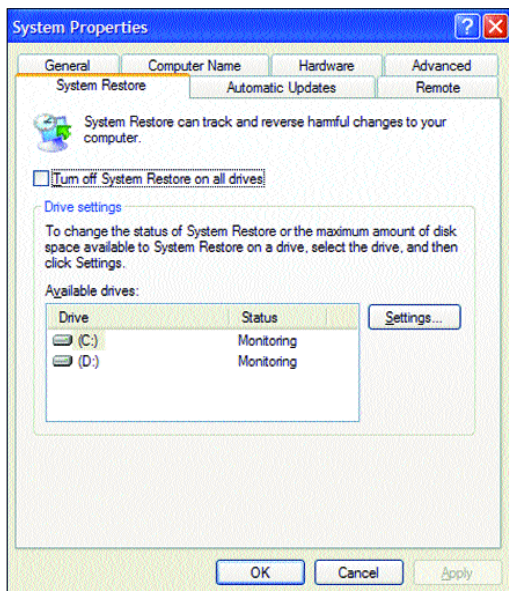
Q I have a Pentium III 500 MHz CPU, 128 MB of RAM, and an 80 GB hard disk running Windows XP Pro. My computer was infected by the W32.Passma virus, so I loaded Norton AntiVirus 2004 Professional and even updated it, but to no avail. Norton detects the virus and deletes files but does not clean the virus out. Help me get rid of this infection!

Girish

A Removing autostart entries from the registry prevents the malware from executing during startup. Here's what you need to do:

Log on as Administrator and open the 'Registry Editor' by going to Start> Run, typing 'regedit', and pressing [Enter]. In the left panel, navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run and locate and delete the entry 'Service Manager = "%System%\SERVICEMGR.EXE"'. Close the Registry Editor.

The next thing you need to do is turn off system restore by pressing [Windows]+[Pause/Break] to go to system properties, click on the System Updates tab and check the 'Turn off



Open the System Properties dialog box and check the 'Turn off System Restore on all drives' option

System Restore on all drives' box. Click 'Apply' and then click 'OK'.

Start Norton AntiVirus, scan all drives and let it delete infected files. Reboot the computer after the scanning is done and then, if you want, re-enable System Restore.

Overheating Blues—Again

Q I have an original Intel 865 GBX motherboard with an Intel Pentium 3.0 GHz processor, 256MB of DDR RAM and an 80 GB HDD. I use an I-Box compatible cabinet. The problem is, my system heats up very quickly. I check the temperature using active monitor; immediately after being switched on, the system temperature rises in no time. I have installed an additional fan and also got the internal cables neatly fixed to a side, but the problem persists. Please suggest what I should do.

Kamesh

A It is extremely likely that your CPU fan is not mounted properly, and that the thermal paste has not been applied correctly. If that is not that case, then you have to check and make sure that your cabinet is properly ventilated. Simply adding extra fans won't necessarily solve the problem—the ventilation may not be adequate, and it is possible that your fans are circulating the same hot air inside.

An ideal setup would be where a front fan sucks in fresh cool air from the outside, and a rear fan sucks the air out from the rear of the cabinet, thereby ensuring there is cross ventilation in the cabinet. This is guaranteed to keep the temperature at acceptable levels.

Mismatched Modules

Q I have a Pentium 4 2.26 GHz and a Mercury motherboard with two memory slots. Each slot can hold a 1 GB RAM stick. There's 128 MB DDR RAM installed in one slot. I would like to install a 256 MB stick in the vacant slot. Would there be a problem if I have two memory slots with memory modules of different capacities?

Goutam Ghosh

A There should be no problem with putting in RAM modules of different capacities. However, you might encounter problems if the RAM frequencies are different.

If you would like to check your RAM frequencies, download a software called Everest from www.lavalys.com. Insert one module at a time and check for the core frequencies. If they match, you will most probably not face a problem.

However, it is not a sure-shot testing method, as different CAS (Column Access Strobe) latency timings might conflict. If the core frequencies match, you can put in the chips and test your system for stability. If the system is stable, keep them inserted, else discard the 128 MB module.